



PLAIN-LANGUAGE USER GUIDE

Hiring, made clear.

A simple guide to requesting a role, reviewing candidates, arranging interviews, and keeping recruitment moving with Smile.

Who is this for?

People who request new staff, HR teams, department heads, managers, recruiters, interviewers, and administrators.

What this portal helps you do

The portal keeps the whole hiring request in one place. What you can see and change depends on the permissions HR has given your account, so some menu items may not appear for you.

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The current workflow
Request a role → HR reviews and the role is approved → HR completes the screening and interview setup → HR publishes the role → candidates apply → Smile assists with CV analysis and an AI phone interview → HR reviews the evidence → the candidate books a face-to-face interview → HR records the final decision.

Stage	Who acts	What the system does
1. Role request	Requester or HR	Creates a staffing request. The form autosaves a draft until it is submitted.
2. HR decision	HR reviewers and approvers	The request is approved, rejected, returned for revision, or placed on hold. There is no separate management-approval stage.
3. Hiring setup	HR	Defines screening criteria, Smile's interview questions, evaluation fields, posting details, and interview requirements.
4. Candidate journey	Candidate and Smile	Candidate applies, Smile analyses the CV, the candidate books an AI Voice Interview and receives the call, and—if approved—books a face-to-face interview.
5. Human decisions	HR	Reviews CV and interview evidence and records the resume, voice, and final interview decisions.

Two ways candidates enter
Candidates can use the public **Open roles** catalogue or a private application link generated by HR for a specific published role. HR can also add a candidate directly from **Resume Screening** or process a batch

of resumes.

About this pilot version

HR sets what each person can do in **User Accounts** , using permissions (see *Who does what?*). Every organisation that uses the portal has its own users, roles, applicants, interview records, and Smile Credits balance; nothing is shared between organisations. The bulk resume upload and cloud imports accept up to **6** files per batch (10 MB each). Google Drive import is available when connected; OneDrive appears only when Microsoft sign-in and administrator consent are configured. The **Credits** page is open to every signed-in user; manual top-ups need the **Manage Smile Credits** permission. Credit purchases run against the HitPay **sandbox** during the pilot. New-applicant notifications and **Smile**, the in-portal help assistant, are included.

What is new in version 1.3

- The AI assistant and credits are now called **Smile** and **Smile Credits**.
- Access is permission-based: HR, Admin, and Custom starting presets, with individual permission switches (section 9).
- The **Credits** page shows the organisation's credit history to everyone and lets you buy credit packs online (section 6).
- AI Voice Interview times are offered every day across the candidate's local day; HR interview hours are automatic, with an **HR Exception Slot** for anything outside them (section 7).
- HR can email an application link straight to a candidate, and candidates may be offered a one-time **Interview with Smile** video option.
- Each organisation can set its own portal name and subtitle in Settings.

Sign in and find your way around

Signing in

1 Open the McLink Recruitment Portal.

Use the link provided by your organisation.

2 Choose “Sign in with Google”.

Use the Google account that HR has activated for you in the portal's User Accounts directory. The email domain alone does not grant access, and the account must be verified and active.

3 Start from the Dashboard.

Your account permissions decide which areas are available.

If you cannot sign in

Make sure you are using the Google account HR registered for you, not a personal account. If access is still denied, contact HR or the portal administrator. If you see a “Limited access” card after signing in, your account is active but has not been given recruitment permissions yet.

Around the screen

- **Left sidebar.** Shows your organisation's portal name, the **Smile Credits** balance, the menu, and your profile and **Sign Out** button. Use the arrow button to collapse or expand it. On a phone, use the **Menu** button.
- **Bell (top bar).** Appears if you can see applicants and shows new applicants (see section 5).
- **Smile button (bottom right).** Opens the in-portal help assistant (see section 10).
- **Back to Dashboard.** Appears at the top of pages such as Settings and Credits.

The main menu

Menu item	What it is for	Who sees it
Dashboard	Hiring activity, the five main steps in the process, and a summary of your own access. Requesters see their own figures; other users see organisation-wide figures.	Everyone
Role Requests	Create, find, filter, and follow staffing requests.	Anyone who can create, review, or approve roles, or review their own department
Resume Screening	Upload resumes, import from Google Drive or OneDrive, run a single CV analysis, and send application links.	Reviewers (Review recruitment)
Applicants	Find candidates, read their information, and record decisions.	Reviewers, approvers, and department reviewers
Bookings	Interview calendars, availability, and appointment records.	Reviewers (Review recruitment)
Settings	Interview and workflow defaults, organisation name and subtitle, and the shared HR Google Calendar connection.	Users with Edit settings
Credits	See the shared balance and credit history, and buy credit packs. Manual top-ups are for authorised users.	Everyone
User Accounts	Add people and control what they can do.	HR access administrators
Profile	View your name, department, access role, and each permission on your account.	Everyone

Who does what?

The portal shows only the actions a person is allowed to use. Access is built from permissions that HR switches on or off for each account. One person can hold several permissions. Open

Profile to see exactly what your own account has.

Permission (as shown in User Accounts)	What it allows
Create role requests	Submit staffing requests and follow, edit, and delete your own requests.
Review recruitment (company-wide)	Run the pipeline: see every role and applicant; return a role for revision, place it on hold, or resume it; complete Recruitment Setup and publish; screen resumes; manage bookings; edit or delete applicants; record applicant decisions.
Approve role requests and hiring decisions	See every role and applicant company-wide, approve or reject role requests, and record Approve or Reject on applicant decisions. It does not include Recruitment Setup, Resume Screening, Bookings, or editing applicant records.
Review own department only	Read-only view of the roles and applicants in your own department. No approvals, edits, deletions, or decisions.
Manage Smile Credits	Add credits manually on the Credits page. Nothing else.
Edit settings	Open Settings: interview and workflow defaults, organisation branding, and the shared HR calendar connection.

Requester

Creates a staffing request and follows the requests they submitted.

Usually sees: Dashboard, Role Requests, Credits, Profile.

HR or Recruiter

Reviews role requests, prepares hiring information, screens candidates, arranges interviews, and manages the hiring list. HR accounts also manage User Accounts. To approve or reject a role, the account also needs the approval permission.

Usually sees: Role Requests, Resume Screening, Applicants, Bookings, Credits, User Accounts.

Approver (for example Management)

Sees every role and applicant company-wide and makes approve or reject decisions, but does not edit setup, screen resumes, arrange interviews, or change applicant records.

Usually sees: Role Requests, Applicants, Credits.

Department Head

Views requests and applicants for their own department only. Read-only.

Usually sees: their department's role requests and applicant records.

Admin (credits)

The **Admin** starting preset manages Smile Credits only. HR decides whether the person needs anything more.

Usually sees: Dashboard, Credits, Profile.

Settings administrator

Maintains portal defaults, the organisation's portal name, and the shared HR Google Calendar connection.

Granted separately with the Edit settings permission.

What you see may be different from a colleague

This is normal. HR chooses one of three starting presets when adding a person — **HR**, **Admin**, or **Custom access** (no elevated access until permissions are selected) — and can then adjust each permission. If you need a menu item or action that is missing, ask HR to review your access.

Create a new role request

Use a role request when your team needs an additional employee or needs to replace someone. Take a few minutes to gather the information before starting.

Before you begin

- ☐ Know the job title and department.
- ☐ Know whether this is a staff addition or a replacement.
- ☐ Have a clear description of the work and the reason for the request.
- ☐ Know the number of people needed and the target hiring date.
- ☐ Have the salary or budget information available if required by your process.

Steps

- 1 Open Role Requests, then select “Create Role Request”.**
- 2 Complete the role details.**

Enter the request type, department, employment type, job title, number of vacancies, and target hiring date.
- 3 Explain the need.**

For a replacement, name the employee or position being replaced. For any request, explain why the role is needed.
- 4 Add HR interview and screening questions if you have them.**

These questions help HR understand what to look for. They can be refined later.
- 5 Review and submit.**

The requester’s name and email are filled from the signed-in account. You cannot change those details in the form.

Tip: use the job description helper

If you have a job description file (PDF, DOC, or DOCX), upload it in the form or paste the description, then choose the option to fill in the form from it. Smile prepares role details, screening criteria, and interview questions for HR to review. Always check the suggested details before submitting.

What happens after submission?

The form autosaves changes as a draft so you can leave and return without losing work. The request is sent to HR only when you submit it, and it must be complete (job title, department, number of vacancies, reason, target hiring date, and job description) before it can be submitted or approved. The requester can follow it from

Role Requests. A saved draft is not a submitted request and does not publish a job. Requesters can edit or delete their own requests, and HR reviewers can edit or delete any request; deleting asks for confirmation first.

Review and approve a role request

Open a request from the Role Requests list to read the details, comments, history, and available actions. HR reviews the request directly from the **Pending HR Discussion** stage — there is no separate management-approval step. Department Heads can open and read requests in their department but cannot act on them.

Finding a request

- Use the **Status** filter to see requests at a particular step.
- Search by job title, role number, department, or requester.
- Use the sort options to find the newest request or the request with the nearest target date.
- Select **Refresh** if another person may have updated the request.

What the status means

Status	Plain meaning	Typical next step
Draft	Still being prepared.	Complete and submit it.
Pending HR Discussion	HR needs to review and decide the request.	HR checks the details and discusses any changes, then the request is approved, rejected, returned for revision, or placed on hold.
Returned for Revision	More information or changes are needed.	Requester or HR updates the request, then a reviewer chooses Resume HR Review .
On Hold	The request is paused.	A reviewer chooses Resume HR Review when the business is ready.
Approved	The role has approval to move forward.	HR completes the hiring setup.
Recruitment Setup	HR is preparing screening and interview details.	Complete the setup and publish when ready.
Job Posted	The role is available for candidates.	Review applicants as they arrive.
Rejected	The request will not move forward.	Read the comments for the reason.

Older records may still show a management-approval status from before that step was retired; their history remains readable.

Making a decision

In the **HR Review** panel, choose the action that matches the decision, enter a comment, and confirm. A comment is required for every role decision. Only the buttons your account is allowed to use are shown:

Button	Permission needed
Approve Role · Reject Role	Approve role requests and hiring decisions
Return for Revision · Place on Hold · Resume HR Review	Review recruitment

If the request has changed since you opened it, refresh the page and review it again before trying the action. If you can only view requests, no decision buttons are shown.

Remember

Approval of a role is not the same as publishing a job. HR still needs to complete the recruitment setup and publish the role.

Prepare and publish an approved role

HR uses Recruitment Setup to tell the portal what to look for in resumes and interviews, and what Smile asks candidates. This page is available to users with Review recruitment. It can be edited while the role is **Approved** or in **Recruitment Setup**; once the role is **Job Posted**, it is read-only.

Complete the screening instructions

- **What should Smile listen for?** Describe the evidence that matters for this role.
- **License or certificate:** State whether one is required, preferred, or not needed.
- **Keywords to look for:** Add useful skills, tools, or terms separated by commas.
- **Transferable skills accepted:** Explain what related experience may count.
- **Minimum relevant experience:** Use a simple requirement such as "None", "3 years", or "5+ years".
- **Approved salary or budget range:** Enter the agreed range if applicable.
- **Earliest availability instructions:** Explain any start-date question to ask.

Set evaluation fields and questions

The portal always considers the candidate's score, recommendation, strengths, and concerns. You can add optional evaluation fields and up to three custom fields ("What should Smile assess?"). Add three to five interview questions: questions 1–3 are required, and questions 4–5 are optional. If the role request supplied HR questions, they appear first and cannot be edited here. The questions are asked as written, so keep them clear, fair, and about the job.

Suggested questions may be shown for review. Treat them as a starting point, edit them as needed, and make sure the final questions are relevant to the job. Do not include questions about protected characteristics such as age, gender, nationality, religion, disability, or family status.

Use the publishing checklist

- ☐ Choose at least one posting channel.
- ☐ Choose salary visibility: **Disclosed** or **Not disclosed**.
- ☐ Choose the license requirement: **Required**, **Preferred**, or **Not required**.
- ☐ Choose whether a **Face-to-Face interview** is required. If required, enter the venue and arrival instructions.

Save and move the role forward

Button	Use it when
Save	You want to save changes and continue working.
Mark as Recruitment Ready	The AI prompt, screening guidance, posting channel, and three required questions are complete.
Mark as Ready for Publishing	The publishing checklist is complete, including the face-to-face venue when required.
Publish Role	The role becomes available in the public Open roles catalogue and for private HR application links.

If a button reports missing fields, complete the fields it lists (or choose the explicit “Not disclosed” or “Not required” option) and try again.

Good practice

Read the script preview before saving. It shows what Smile would say on a real call, using a made-up candidate, so you can catch unclear wording. Use “Advanced: edit full script” only if you need to change the whole script.

Screen and manage applicants

Open the applicant list

Choose **Applicants** to see the candidate list. Use the search box to find a candidate, role, email, or application number. Use the role and stage filters to narrow the list. Choose 10, 25, or 50 rows per page.

New-applicant notifications

A bell in the top bar and a badge on **Applicants** show how many applicants have applied since you last opened the Applicants page. HR and approvers see new applicants company-wide; a Department Head sees only their own department's. Opening the bell lists the new candidates and links straight to each record. Opening the Applicants page clears the count; a candidate who applies after that appears as new again. Users who cannot see applicants have no bell.

Pilot limitation: the "last seen" mark is stored in your browser, so the new/seen state is per browser and per device and does not follow you between devices.

Understand the summary cards

Applications
Total applications in the available history.

Resume Screened
Applications that have been processed and are ready for review.

Voice Interview
Candidates with activity in the phone interview stage.

Face-to-Face Interview
Candidates who have moved beyond the AI Voice Interview stage.

Read an applicant record

Select **View** beside a candidate. The record brings together contact information, role, the resume, Smile's CV analysis, voice interview evidence, interview activity, decisions, and the candidate's status history. From the header you can jump to the role or to all applicants for that role. Use the resume and interview information only for recruitment purposes.

Record HR decisions

The **HR Decisions** panel shows the stage the candidate is at. Choose **Approve** or **Reject** and enter a comment — a comment is required every time. Decisions are made in order, and completed decisions stay visible with their comments.

Decision	What happens after Approve
AI CV Analysis	The candidate is invited by email to book an AI Voice Interview.
Voice Interview Review	The candidate is invited by email to book a Face-to-Face Interview.
Face-to-Face Interview Decision	Record the outcome after the meeting has taken place. Approve marks the candidate as having passed the final interview.

Users with Review recruitment or the approval permission can record decisions. Only users with Review recruitment can **Edit applicant** (name, email, and local phone number) or **Delete applicant**.

Send a personal application link

HR can invite one person to apply for one published role. The link opens the familiar candidate application page with the role and invited person's details already prepared.

1 Open **Resume Screening** and find "Send an application link".

2 Choose the published role.

Only roles that are ready to accept applications can be selected.

3 Enter the candidate's name and email address.

Check the spelling carefully before continuing.

4 Choose how to send it.

Select "Generate application link" and copy the link to send it yourself, or select "Generate & send email" to email it to the candidate. The email includes the required AI interview notice.

5 Check Applicants after the candidate submits.

The link is for one successful application only and expires after a few days (7 by default). If it expires or has already been used, generate a new one.

Keep invitation links private

The link is tied to the selected role and invited candidate. Do not post it in a group chat or send it to someone else.

Common applicant stages

Stage	What it means
Resume Review	The resume and CV analysis have been received and need human review.
Resume Approved	The candidate can move to the phone interview step.
Voice Booking Pending	The candidate needs to choose a phone interview time.
Voice Interview Scheduled	A phone interview time has been booked.
Voice Interview Review	The phone interview result is ready for HR to review. If the call was not completed, the record explains that no completed interview was available.
Approved for Face-to-Face Interview	The candidate can choose a Face-to-Face Interview time.
Face-to-Face Interview Scheduled	A Face-to-Face Interview time has been booked.
Face-to-Face Decision Pending	The face-to-face meeting is complete and HR still needs to record the outcome.
Passed Final Interview	The candidate passed the final interview step.
Rejected · Withdrawn	The candidate will not move to the next step.

Deleting a record is permanent

Deleting an applicant also removes related screening information, history, and interview times. Check carefully before confirming.

Screen resumes

Users with Review recruitment screen resumes for a published role from [Resume Screening](#) . The page has three parts: **Bulk upload resumes**, **Send an application link** (section 5), and **CV Analysis** for a single resume. Each file is checked for duplicates, queued, and tracked on the page.

Upload several resumes from your computer

- 1 Choose the published role.**
Pick the role that matches every resume in this batch.
- 2 Add the files.**
Drag them into the box or click the box to choose them. PDF, DOC, and DOCX files are accepted. You can add up to 6 files per batch in the pilot, with a 10 MB limit per file. Each resume that screens successfully uses one Smile Credit; duplicates and files that fail before a successful analysis are not charged.
- 3 Select “Start screening”.**
The portal sends the resumes for processing and shows each one in the queue.
- 4 Watch the progress.**
The list updates automatically. You can also choose “Refresh status”.
- 5 Review the applicants.**
When processing is complete, choose “View Processed Applicants” to begin the human review. If some files fail, “Retry failed” resubmits only those files.

Screen a single resume

Use the **CV Analysis** card at the bottom of the page: choose the role, enter the candidate's details, attach the resume, and select **Start CV Analysis**. The candidate then appears in [Applicants](#) . It uses one Smile Credit when the analysis succeeds.

Import from Google Drive

Choose the published role first. The first time you use this, select **Connect Google Drive** and sign in with the Google account you want to use for your own Drive files (HR only; read-only access). After that, select **Choose from Google Drive**, browse My Drive or an available Shared Drive, tick the files you want (PDF, DOC, or DOCX; up to 6 per import), and confirm. Imported resumes go through the same screening pipeline, duplicate check, and one-credit-per-successful-file rule as a computer upload.

Import from OneDrive

When enabled for the deployment, OneDrive import works like Google Drive import: the same 6-file limit, 10 MB per file, accepted file types, duplicate check, and one-credit-per-successful-file rule apply. Select **Connect OneDrive**, sign in with the Microsoft account used for your own files (HR only), then choose **Choose from OneDrive**. **Deployment dependent** The buttons stay hidden until the Microsoft app registration, redirect URL, and administrator consent have been configured.

Queue messages

Message	What to do
Queued	Wait. The file has been accepted and is waiting to be processed.
Processing	Wait. The portal is reading and checking the resume.
Completed	Open the applicant list and review the candidate.
Skipped	The file was already handled for this role.
Failed	Check the file and choose "Retry failed". Use a readable, unlocked PDF, DOC, or DOCX.

Important

Automatic screening is an aid for HR, not a final hiring decision. Smile compares the resume with the role's criteria and gives a score, strengths, and gaps, but a score is never an approval or rejection. Always review the resume and supporting information yourself.

Credits, balance, and payment

Smile Credits meter the AI features. The balance is **shared by everyone in your organisation**. You can always see it in the sidebar (and the mobile header), and in full on the [Credits](#) page. Booking a time, creating a role request, and commenting never cost credits.

What uses credits

Action	Credits
AI CV analysis (each resume that screens successfully)	1
AI phone interview — completed	10
AI phone interview — connected but incomplete	8
AI phone interview — candidate did not answer	5
Duplicate resume for the same role, or a failed or invalid file	0 — not charged

The Credits page

The page has three parts: **Buy Smile Credits** (credit packs), the **Credit balance** (current balance, total added, total consumed, and — for authorised users — the top-up form), and the **Organization credit history**. Everyone in the organisation can read the history. Search it, filter by *All activity / Credits added / Credits used* and by event (*Manual changes, CV analysis, Voice interviews*), and page through it ten entries at a time. Each entry shows when it happened, the event, the change, the balance after it, a reference, and who did it.

Who can do what

Access	What is available
Any signed-in user	View the shared balance and the organisation's credit history, and start a credit-pack purchase.
Users with Manage Smile Credits	Manual top-ups Add credits with the Adjust balance form. The Admin preset has this permission; HR can grant it to anyone.

Add credits manually (demo / adjustment)

On [Credits](#), enter a **positive whole number** under **Adjust balance** and a **Note** explaining why (required), then select **Update Balance**. Manual changes can only add credits. The adjustment is written to the credit history with your name, the amount, the note, the time, and the resulting balance, and it takes effect immediately for new AI actions. The balance is never changed without a history entry, and re-submitting the same adjustment does not add the credits twice. By default, a single top-up of **2,000 credits or more** earns an automatic **10% bonus**, shown as a separate "Volume bonus" entry.

Buy credits (HitPay)

1 Choose a credit pack.

Each pack shows its credits and price in Singapore dollars. Credits are priced at S\$0.40 each; by default the packs are Starter (10 credits, S\$4), Standard (50 credits, S\$20), and Bulk (100 credits, S\$40). Your

deployment may offer different packs. You only choose a pack — never a price or a credit amount.

2 Select “Pay with HitPay” and pay.

You are taken to the secure HitPay checkout to complete payment, then returned to the Credits page.

3 Wait for confirmation.

The page shows “Verifying your payment and credit balance...”. Credits are added only after HitPay confirms the payment to the portal directly — returning to the page is not enough on its own. This usually takes a few seconds. When it succeeds you will see “Payment Successful”, the credits added, and your new balance.

Pilot

Payments in the pilot run against the HitPay **sandbox** — no real money moves. If purchases have not been set up for the deployment, the page says “Credit purchases are currently unavailable. Please contact an administrator.”

Payment statuses

Status	Meaning
Pending	Payment started, not yet confirmed. No credits added yet.
Paid	Confirmed by HitPay. Credits have been added to the balance.
Failed	Payment did not complete. No credits added.
Expired / Cancelled	The payment link lapsed or was cancelled. No credits added.

If confirmation is slow, the page offers **Check payment again**, which re-checks the payment with HitPay without creating a second charge or a duplicate credit.

When the balance is too low

An AI action that the balance cannot cover is refused before any work is done, with a message showing how many credits are needed and how many remain. Top up (manually or by purchase) and try again. Existing screening and interview results are never lost.

Schedule and follow interviews

How interview times work

	AI Voice Interview	Face-to-Face (HR) Interview
Who runs it	Smile, by phone	HR, in person at the venue HR set for the role
Times offered	Every day, in 10-minute times across the candidate's local day	Monday–Friday, one-hour times from 10:00 to 16:00, excluding 12:00–13:00 (lunch), in office time (Singapore)
Set up by	Automatic — nothing to configure	Automatic, and checked against the shared HR Google Calendar. HR can add exception slots.
Capacity	Up to 10 calls at the same moment across all roles; a full time disappears from the list	One candidate per time; a time that conflicts with a calendar event is blocked

Candidates only see times in the current calendar month and on or before the role's target hiring date, and they never see the full internal calendar — only individual times when they book. Booking links are single-use and expire after a few days (7 by default; a settings editor can change this).

View the interview calendars

HR opens **Bookings** (*Interview Calendars*) to see the **AI Voice Interview Calendar** and the **Face-to-Face Interview Calendar** side by side, with counts of active time windows, available times, scheduled appointments, and completed interviews. Use the **Role** and **Interview type** filters, **Today**, and the month arrows to move around. Select a date to see open times, scheduled candidates, completed interviews, no-shows, and conflicts. Below the calendars, **Appointment records** lists every booking with search, a status filter, and 10, 25, or 50 rows per page; select **View Applicant** to jump to the candidate.

Add an HR exception slot

Standard weekday hours are already available automatically. Use an exception slot for a Saturday, a holiday, or extended hours.

1. Choose **+ HR Exception Slot**.
2. Choose an approved role.
3. Enter the date, start and end time, and timezone (Asia/Singapore, Asia/Manila, or Asia/Kuala Lumpur).
4. Check the notice. It says whether the time is already covered by standard hours or will be added as an exception, and reports the Google Calendar check.
5. Select **Save exception slot**. The slot appears on the calendar straight away.

When a candidate books

The selected time becomes a scheduled appointment, the candidate receives a confirmation, and the calendar is updated. The portal records the timezone so the candidate and HR see the same appointment time.

If a candidate does not attend

Open the date details, find the scheduled appointment, and choose **Mark No Show** after the interview time has started. Confirm the action. This keeps the attendance record clear and allows the team to decide whether to offer another time.

Calendar connection

Face-to-Face Interview availability is checked against the shared HR Google Calendar. If it is not connected, ask the person who manages Settings to connect or reconnect it (see section 9).

Phone (voice) interview

When HR approves a candidate at the resume stage, the candidate is emailed a secure link to book an AI Voice Interview. The candidate chooses a date and time, confirms a preferred mobile number, and is called automatically at the booked time. The times are shown in the candidate's own timezone. The email and booking page disclose that Smile, an AI interviewer, will conduct the call, that responses may be recorded, transcribed, and assessed, and that the recruitment team reviews the results. Smile's result, transcript, scores, strengths, concerns, and follow-up questions return to the applicant record.

Calls that come back as No Answer, Busy, Wrong Person, or No Show follow a retry lifecycle rather than counting as a completed interview (by default up to 3 attempts, 24 hours apart; a settings editor can change both). When a call was not answered or was incomplete, the **Voice Interview Review** panel shows **Send reschedule link**: HR chooses to send the candidate a fresh booking link, and no call is placed until the candidate books a new time.

Interview with Smile (video option)

Where enabled for the deployment, the voice-interview invitation may also include an **Interview with our Avatar now** button. It opens a one-time private page where Smile asks one focused question about the candidate's application on video. The response is transcribed and summarised for the recruitment team as an interview aid — it is not an automated hiring decision, and the link stops working once used or after it expires.

Face-to-face interview

After HR approves a candidate at the voice-interview stage, the candidate is emailed a new private link and books a Face-to-Face Interview against the shared HR calendar. The candidate is added as an attendee on the calendar event, and the **venue or address** HR entered in Recruitment Setup is included in the invitation and shown on the completed booking in the portal. After the meeting, HR records the outcome in the **Face-to-Face Interview Decision** panel on the applicant record.

For candidates: applying and booking

Apply for a role

1 Open the job application page.

Choose a role from the public

Open roles

catalogue and select "View and apply", or open the private link sent by HR. The role and your name may already be filled in.

2 Enter your details.

Provide your name, email address, country, and mobile number.

3 Attach your resume.

Use a readable PDF, DOC, or DOCX file and check that the file is the correct version.

4 Review the privacy and consent message.

Continue only when you understand and agree to the stated use of your information.

5 Submit the application once.

A confirmation message means the application was received. The role must be published and accepting applications. Sending the form again may create another application. If you were sent a private link that has already been used or has expired, the page will say so.

Book a phone interview

Open the private booking link in the invitation email. The page and the email explain that Smile, McLink Group's AI interview assistant, will conduct the interview and that the recruitment team will review your responses. Enter your local mobile number without the country code, choose a date, choose a time, and confirm. Keep the confirmation email, and make sure you are available and in a quiet place at the booked time. If the page says no times are available, reply to your invitation email so the recruitment team can help.

Book a face-to-face interview

If HR invites you to the next step, open the new booking link and choose from the available times. The confirmation shows the date, time, and venue. The page also shows whether the interview is scheduled, completed, or no longer available.

Keep booking links private

These links are personal and can be used only once. Do not forward them to another person or post them in a group chat. If the link does not work or has expired, contact the recruitment team and ask for a new invitation.

User accounts, organisations, and settings

These pages are for HR access administrators and settings editors. If you cannot see them in the menu, your account does not have the permission.

User Accounts

Only **HR** accounts with Review recruitment can manage people. Open **User Accounts** to see everyone in your organisation, with summary counts of total accounts, active accounts, and settings administrators.

1 Select "Add user account".

2 Enter the full name and email address.

This must be the Google account the person will sign in with.

3 Choose an access role and department.

HR

,

Admin

(Smile Credits only), or

Custom access

(no elevated access). Choosing a role fills in its recommended permissions.

4 Adjust the permission switches.

Create role requests · Review recruitment · Review own department only · Approve role requests and hiring decisions · Manage Smile Credits · Edit settings. Give each person only what they need.

5 Save.

The account can sign in immediately.

Use **Edit** to change a person's details or permissions. Use **Deactivate** to remove access — accounts are deactivated rather than deleted so history is preserved, and **Reactivate** restores access. You cannot deactivate your own account. Changes apply to future actions and page visibility; they do not delete recruitment history.

Organisations (platform administrators)

A McLink platform administrator also sees an **Organizations** section. **Add organization** takes a name and a lowercase slug (the slug cannot be changed once created). Use **Manage users for** to switch to another organisation before adding its users. Each organisation's users, departments, roles, applicants, interview records, and Smile Credits stay separate, and adding a new organisation does not copy any existing records into it.

Settings

Users with Edit settings open **Settings**. Changes apply to new actions and never rewrite existing records. Blank values return to the default. Only settings that are live for your deployment are shown, and secrets never appear here.

Setting	What it controls	Default
Final Interview Calendar Email / ID	The shared HR Google Calendar used for face-to-face interviews.	—
Booking Link Expiry Days	How long a voice or face-to-face booking link stays valid (1–30).	7
Resume Screening Link Expiry Days	How long an HR-generated application link stays valid (1–30).	7
Bulk Resume Upload Concurrency	How many resumes a bulk upload processes at once (1–10).	5
Bulk Resume Notify On Success	Whether a “batch complete” email is sent after a bulk upload.	No
Voice Call Max Attempts / Retry Gap Hours	How many AI call attempts a candidate gets, and the wait between them.	3 / 24
Credit discount threshold / percent	The top-up size that earns a bonus, and the bonus.	2,000 / 10%

Organisation branding

Under **Organization branding**, set the **display name** and **portal subtitle** shown in the header and navigation for your organisation only, then select **Save branding**. This changes the label users see; it does not change permissions or which data belongs to the organisation.

Google Calendar connection

Under **Google Calendar connection**, select **Connect Google Calendar** and sign in with the account that owns the shared HR calendar. The page shows **Connected** when it is working, and **Account mismatch** or **Reconnect Google Calendar** if the connected account is not the expected one. Reconnect it if the Face-to-Face calendar shows no times or bookings fail.

Common questions

“I cannot see a role or applicant.”

Your access may limit you to your own requests, your department, or read-only views. Open [Profile](#) to check your permissions, then ask HR to confirm that you have the right access.

“A menu item is missing.”

Menu items appear only when your account has the matching permission (see *Who does what?*). Ask HR to review your access.

“My request is not moving.”

Check the status and latest comment on the request. It may be waiting for HR to review, returned for more information, or on hold.

Ask Smile (in-portal help)

The portal includes a help assistant called **Smile** for common questions about how the portal works. Select the **Smile** button at the bottom right and type your question. Smile explains features and steps, and can tell you your organisation's current Smile Credits balance and, if you work with the pipeline, simple queue and interview counts. Smile does not make hiring decisions, cannot see candidate records, resumes, scores, or calendars, and cannot change anything — so do not enter candidate personal data or passwords. If Smile says it “is currently being configured”, the assistant is not switched on yet; contact HR or the portal administrator for help.

“The role was approved but candidates cannot apply.”

Approval is only one step. HR must complete the Recruitment Setup checklist and publish the role.

“A resume failed.”

Make sure it is a readable, unlocked PDF, DOC, or DOCX file and no larger than 10 MB. Try the retry option. If it still fails, ask HR to check the file or enter the candidate another way. A failed file is not charged a Smile Credit.

“There are not enough Smile Credits.”

The AI action is refused before any work is done — nothing is lost. Buy a credit pack on the [Credits](#) page, or ask a user with Manage Smile Credits to add credits. See section 6.

“I paid but the credits are not showing.”

Credits are added only when the payment provider confirms the payment to the portal directly, which is usually seconds but can lag. On the [Credits](#) page, select **Check payment again**. If it has still not appeared after a few minutes, ask a user with Manage Smile Credits or the portal administrator for help, and quote the payment reference shown on the page.

“The calendar shows no times.”

Check the role and interview-type filters, choose the correct month, and refresh. Times run only up to the role's target hiring date. For Face-to-Face Interviews, ask the settings administrator to check the shared HR Google Calendar connection, or add an HR exception slot.

“A candidate says their link does not work.”

Links are personal, single-use, and expire after a few days. If a link has expired or been used, generate a new application link, or for interviews open the applicant record and use **Send reschedule link** where it is offered.

“The page says someone else changed the record.”

Refresh the page, read the latest information, and then try again. This prevents one person's changes from replacing another person's work.

Good practice

Do

- Use clear, job-related information.
- Check details before submitting or publishing.
- Keep candidate information private.
- Use human judgment alongside screening results.
- Add a useful comment with every role and applicant decision.

Do not

- Share private booking links.
- Use personal accounts for company recruitment work.
- Make a hiring decision based only on an automated score.
- Upload a resume to the wrong role.
- Delete records unless you are sure they should be removed.

Need more help?

Take a screenshot of the message, note the role or application number, and contact HR or the portal administrator. Do not include passwords or private booking links.

This guide describes the McLink Recruitment Portal interface and usual hiring process as at version 1.3 (21 September 2026). Your organisation's access rules and hiring policies always take priority.